

6. LUCY GRAY

BY WILLIAM WORDSWORTH

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William Wordsworth was an English Romantic poet, best known for his contributions to the literary movement that emphasized nature, emotion, and individualism. A central figure in the Romantic era, he is most famous for his poetry collection *Lyrical Ballads* (1798), co-authored with Samuel Taylor Coleridge, which marked the beginning of Romanticism in English literature. Wordsworth's works often explore the beauty of nature, human emotions, and the innocence of childhood. His most renowned poems include "I Wandered Lonely as a Cloud," "Tintern Abbey," and "Ode: Intimations of Immortality." He became England's Poet Laureate in 1843.



Lucy Gray, a solitary child,
Lived on a wide moor,
No companions or friends,
Only nature at her door.

Her father asked her to go
Into the town through the snow,
With a lantern to light her way
But she never reached her goal.

The storm came fierce and strong,
Lucy wandered, but for long
She never made it to the town,
And was lost in the snowstorm's frown.

The poem suggests that Lucy's spirit still haunts the moors,
Her face never seen, but her memory endures.

EXERCISE 1- WORDS/EXPRESSIONS & THEIR MEANINGS

S. #	Words	Meaning in English
1.	Wild	uncultivated tracts of land
2.	Solitary	alone
3.	Mate	regular companion
4.	Comrade	companion
5.	Dwelt	resided
6.	Moor	open swampy wasteland
7.	Spy	see
8.	Fawn	young deer
9.	Yonder	there
10.	Faggot Band	a band holding a bundle of sticks
11.	blither	cheerful
12.	wanton	excessively merry
13.	wretched	unhappy
14.	thence	from that place
15.	spied	discovered
16.	hawthorn hedge	thorny bush

EXERCISE 1- POST READING

Q1. Who was Lucy Gray?

Ans. Lucy Gray was a small, innocent and obedient child and only the offspring of her parent. She was living in the western countryside that's why she had no neighbors and friend of her age to play with her. According to the poet, there is a lot of living things in form of human, birds, and animals but she was the most marvelous and the most striking obsession whose beauty, innocence and charm were absolutely unparalleled.

Q2. What is the main idea or the Central idea of the poem, 'Lucy Gray'?

Ans. 'A thing of beauty is a joy forever.'

"Lucy Gray" follows this theme, as it shows the young, innocent Lucy disappearing into the vast world of nature and being alive in the memories of the people. Lucy Gray is about the merger of humanness with nature. Lucy is the name of a child who is sweet, innocent and pure. Two of the main themes throughout Wordsworth's poem concern nature and the loss of a loved one. Lucy not only lives away from society on the moors, but she also travels through the wilderness. Lucy is depicted as an innocent child who enjoys the natural environment. She undergoes a transition from a human being into a spirit that is free to roam in nature, hence Wordsworth stresses on the famous Romantic belief that natural beauty is eternal and everlasting. Nature does not let Lucy die rather it has preserved her and that's why she is still alive in nature as a free spirit, fresh in the memories of the people.

Q3. Why did Lucy father ask her to go to the town?

Ans. Lucy father asked her to go to the town to bring back her mother back because her mother went to the town because of some work and he is predicting by seeing the moon for the storm so he asked her to take lantern for the light and go to the town instantly so she could back before the storm. He did so because he was busy in his work and was expecting that they could come back easily before the storm would come.

Q4. How did Lucy's parent come to know that they have lost their child?

Ans. Lucy's poor parent searched their child far and wide but they could not any sign of her presence so they were disappointed and depresses but suddenly her mother saw her footprints at the edge of the hill which was at downwards so they started to follow them that led them to a wooden bridge. Further, they tracked those footmarks and in the middle of the bridge, they found the bridge broken. Then they got the reality of their daughter's terrible death which was caused by drowning.

Q5. How did Lucy become immortal?

Ans. Lucy had become immortal because after her death the people began to believe that she was still a living child who could be seen alone at the break of the day only those who had the deep concern with natural beauty. She was seen by singing a solitary song in the moor, walking rough and smooth and never looked behind.

"To live in hearts we leave behind is not to die."

Thomas Campbell

Q6. Describe the tragic event that happened with Lucy Gray?

Ans. Lucy Grey was a child who lived along with her parents on wild moor. One day her mother went to the town for some work but at that day there was a great chance of storm

so her father told her to go the town to bring her mother back and suggested to take a lantern with her. She gladly agreed to go and hurriedly went. When she was on the way, unfortunately, storm came before its time and she could not reach the town and lost her way. Her parent desperately searched her whole night but after some effort, they found that she was dead. But still, some people believe that Lucy Gray is alive and sometimes is seen to walk alone over the moor. William Wordsworth's "Lucy Gray" tells the story of an innocent young girl who is lost in the wild and never found again. The suggestion is that she dies, although at the end Wordsworth suggests Lucy might still dwell in the wilderness somewhere far from civilization. It's unclear whether he's implying that Lucy is still alive, or if he's merely suggesting that her spirit lives on in the natural world.

Q7. Why does Wordsworth call Lucy a solitary child?

Ans. Lucy Gray lived with her parents on the wild moors. Wordsworth called Lucy Gray a solitary child because she had no companion or friend of her age to play with her. She was always seen playing with wild animals and flowers. She was mostly seen walking alone over the uncultivated tract of the land of that area. Here Wordsworth also stresses on the fact that Lucy was a solitary child and was always surrounded with nature. She was detached from the human world as she had no human friends or companions but was mostly seen playing with animals or flowers on the wild moor. So he is telling us here that she was a child of nature.

Q8. Why does Wordsworth call Lucy a living child?

Ans. Wordsworth does not clearly indicate in the poem if Lucy was dead, rather he calls her a living child, leaving the reader with a tinge of curiosity if Lucy was alive or dead. But Lucy never returned home and her parents, who had followed her footsteps till the middle of the bridge and then could not see any footsteps further, had understood that Lucy was dead. However Wordsworth stresses that Lucy is a living child. According to the poet Lucy is a living child because she might be dead from the human world but she is alive in nature. Nature has preserved Lucy along with her body since she was pure at heart and was a naturally beautiful child. So nature does not let her die rather she has transformed from human world to the natural world. The fact that people can still hear her singing and see her playing on moor because she is alive in their memories and thoughts.